

6.1 Mobile Blogging

Blogging has been one of the biggest revolutions on the Internet. The idea of a citizen journalist too has shaped up somewhat, and this is a quick and effective way of dispensing information to a potential mass audience. The concept of an extended Internet with humans as the node points has started becoming a reality because of the use of mobile devices to access the Internet. It is, essentially, the possibility of logging on to the network no matter where you are.

As explained earlier, accessing the Internet on the mobile phone has become a norm. Just as most tools available on the Net can today be accessed on your mobile, so can newer applications such as blogging tools and networking tools.

Mobile blogging is not just accessing a blog on your mobile device—it also means adding a post onto your blog or sending a photograph or any audio or video file to your blog, all with the help of a mobile device. This mobile device can be a mobile phone, a laptop, a PDA, or any other device that affords mobility.

Technologically, the earliest developments in ‘moblogging’ happened in Japan. The reason is simple—Japan was one of the first countries where camera phones were used widely. Though the first post onto the internet from a mobile device was done in 1995, the blogger used a wearable computer and not a mobile phone. The first post onto the Internet using a conventional mobile phone happened in May 2000, and is credited to Tom Vilmer Paamand of Denmark.

The term moblogging was coined a couple of years later by Adam Greenfield. Greenfield also went on to organise the first mobile blogging conference (1IMC) in Tokyo in July 2003. The burst in the popularity of moblogs came after the tsunami that hit India and parts of SE Asia in December 2004, when much of the information about relief operations and ground conditions were put up on the Internet with the help of mobile phones.